

Exploring Social Sharing in Photo Editing

UR Team March '25 

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What is the **purpose** of this research?

- What are the current behaviors of users **when consulting with others** about which photos to edit, share or while editing?
- How, if at all, do users currently **collaborate on group photos**?
- How do **attitudes towards Facetune** influence the way users use + discuss Facetune **with others**?

What was done

Audience

100 users answered a survey:

- FT users who might also use other editing apps
- Takes photos regularly with emphasis on selfies
- Aged between 18 to 64

Attitudes towards Facetune

Users are comfortable sharing Facetune use with close circles but are more hesitant beyond that

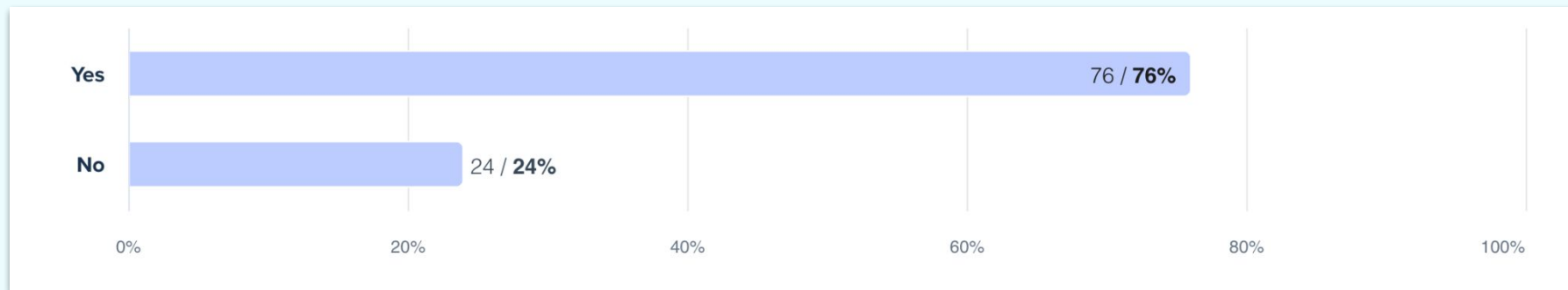
	1	2	3	4	5	Mean
Comfortable sharing with family	3	3	11	38	45	4.2
Comfortable sharing with close friends	3	2	5	39	51	4.3
Comfortable sharing with casual friends	4	11	26	38	21	3.6
Comfortable sharing with acquaintances	13	23	15	26	23	3.2
	Not at all comfortable				Very comfortable	

Comfort is high with close friends and family but decreases with casual friends and acquaintances. This suggests potential stigma or social perception concerns, **calling for deeper exploration**

**Current behaviors when
consulting with others**

76% of users discuss or get input from others about their photos

This could be when choosing which photos to edit, while editing, letting others help with editing, deciding which photos to share, or talking about group photos



24% of users who **don't** discuss with others **trust** **their judgment** and **don't** seek outside opinions, while some **avoid sharing due to embarrassment**

***The majority of this group were **aged b/w 45-64**

"If I consult with others about my editing of my pictures then they'll know that I edit my pictures"

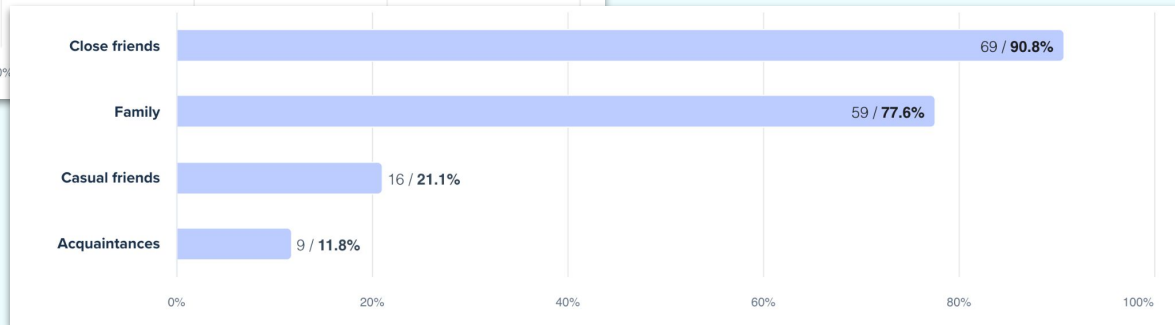
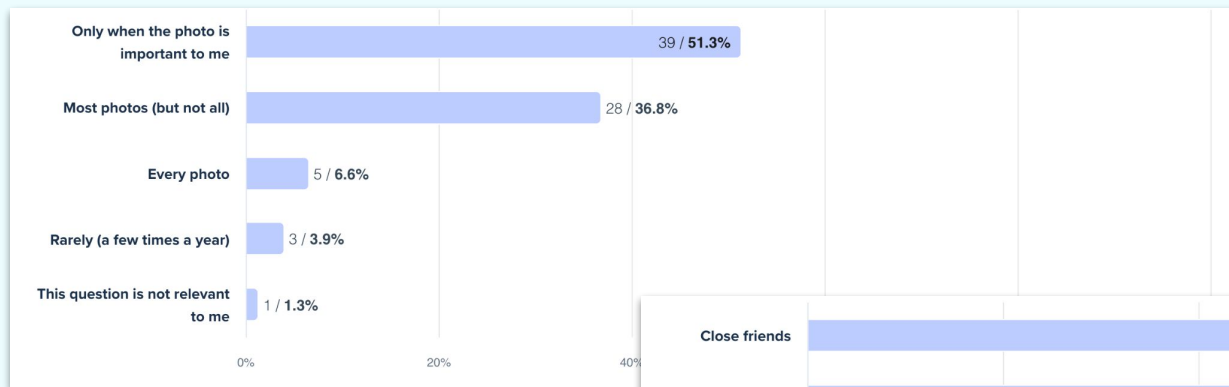
"I don't want to appear too self conscious or like I don't have good self esteem"

"It feels private and sometimes a tiny bit embarrassing"

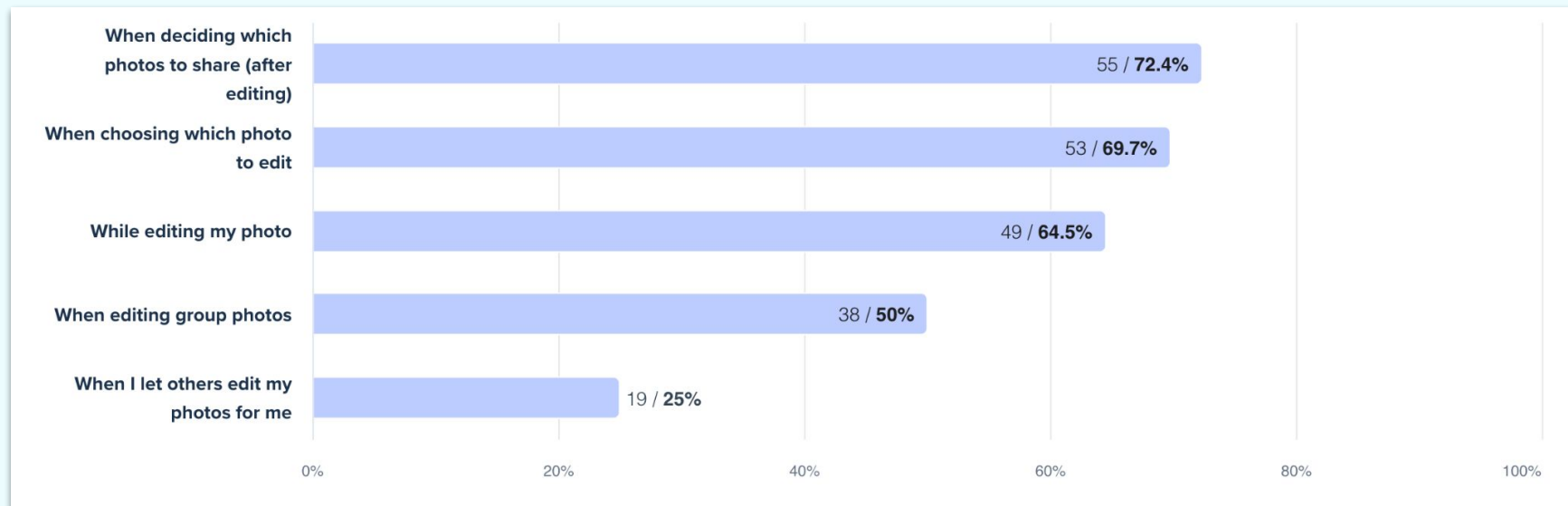
"Because I want to edit the picture based on my taste and what i think looks good"

"I like to make decisions based on my own perceptions"

Users typically consult 1–4 close friends or family when deciding which photos to edit, share or adjust while editing, mainly for important photos



Users seek the most input when choosing which photos to share or edit but are significantly less likely to let others edit for them—indicating a desire to control their edits



Users prefer to remain in control of the editing process

*"I **ask for input** and **do the edits myself**"*

*"I **ask their opinion** if they look too edited or not. **If they say it does I start over with less editing.** If not I'll share the photo"*

*"They **show me** what to do"*

*"I ask them to edit, but often **I also edit myself in case I don't love what they do**"*

*"I keep editing until **I feel I've done it a bit too much**—then **I go back and refine my edits**"*

*"I **generally don't ask for others to edit the photos** unless they have very specific edits that they can't explain in words to me"*

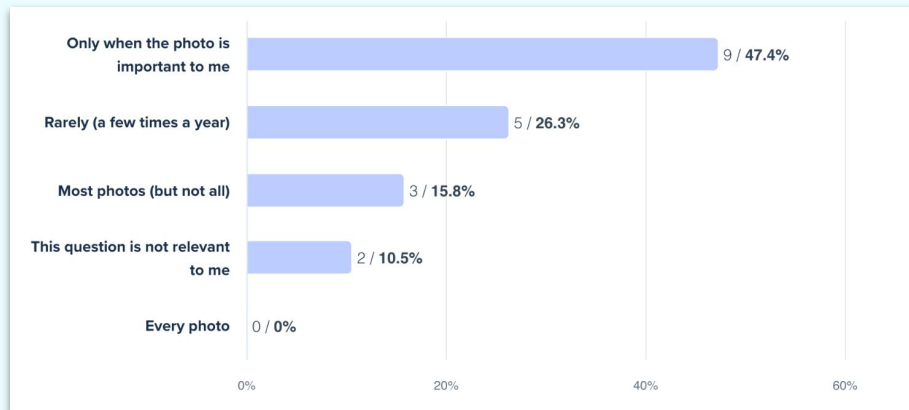
*"I **never have help with editing unless the person is physically right by me.** I never share the 'original' over messaging apps"*

Letting others edit photos is not routine, and usually happens only when the other person is seen as more skilled

*"Some people are just **selfie experts** so it helps to have their advice"*

*"Occasionally my daughter will edit my photos because **she's much better at it** than me"*

*"I send some photos to my sister to edit **who is really good at it**"*



What feedback do users seek when deciding which photos to edit, share, or while editing?

Ensuring a natural & realistic look

Users want confirmation that their edits aren't excessive or unrealistic

*"Seeing if I **overdid it**, if it **looks natural**, and if it **still looks like me** in the end"*

Refining edits for better presentation

Users ask for feedback on lighting, filters, and composition to enhance their photos and make them visually appealing

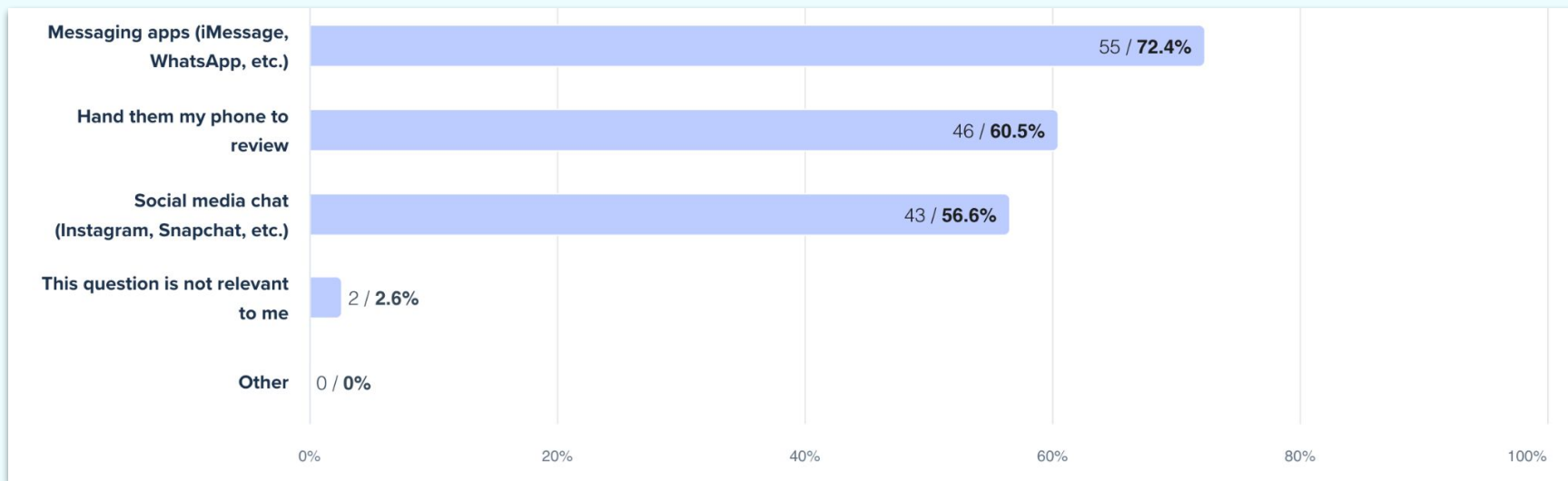
*"I seek feedback on the edits such as **lighting, filters, or touch-ups**—because it helps my photo **look its best** before sharing"*

Seeking Approval & Social Validation

Users ask if the photo is "good enough" to post, often relying on others' opinions for final decisions

*"Getting other people's opinions helps me see how a **larger audience would react** to these pictures objectively"*

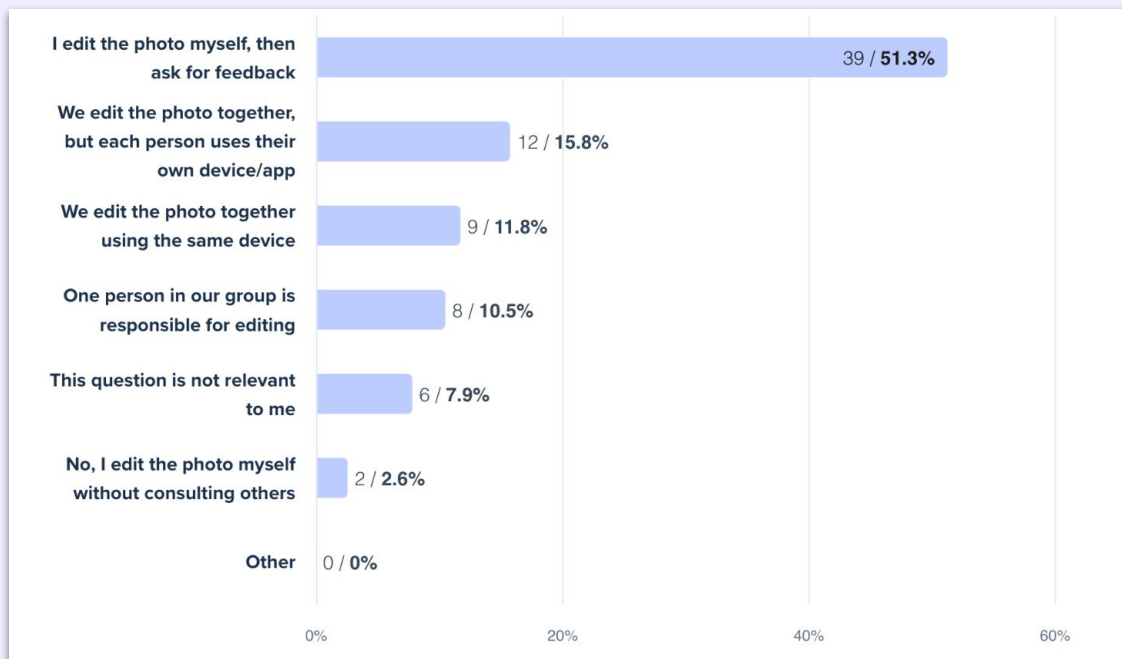
Users share photos for feedback through various methods, with no strong preference, suggesting their choice depends on convenience and context



Collaboration on group photos

Most users prefer editing group photos themselves first and then seeking feedback, rather than collaborating in real-time

A minority of users collaborate on edits, but even then, each person edits their own appearance before sending it back, *ensuring individual control*



After editing, users ensure the final version is flattering for everyone and that edits are acceptable

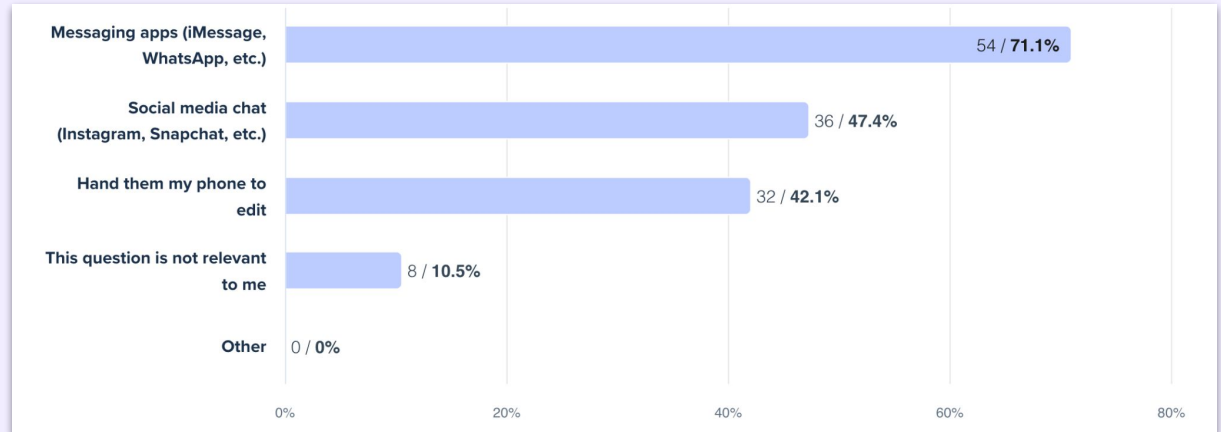
*"I send the photo to make sure **everyone** is happy with how they look"*

*"I edit group photos **myself** to ensure everyone looks their best, **then ask for feedback** by sharing the edited version in a group chat"*

*"I **take everyone's input**, **edit the image**, **get new input** if they like what I did or dislike it, and **then edit again** if needed"*

Users consult on group photos on most group photos or important ones, significantly preferring messaging apps (71.1%) for feedback

It can be inferred that messaging apps are preferred because (1) they allow the group to see edits in one place, making feedback easier and (2) common behavior of communicating



Appendix

A minority of users collaborate on edits, but even then, each person edits their own appearance before sending it back, ensuring individual control

*"We each **edit our own portion then send them all to one person** and they put it all together"*

*"Sometimes I'll share my edited photo in a text message so they **can edit themselves on their own phone before sending the updated photo back to me**"*

*"We use **multiple apps, but each person is their own editor**, so we all pick between 3-5 face apps for editing"*

*"Each person gets to look at the photo and **only gets to change themselves or have input** on things like background, lighting, etc."*